

K12 Schools

Requisition Approval Overview

PROCUREMENT GUIDE

What a requisition is, who approves it, typical thresholds, and best practices

What Is a Requisition?

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Definition

A purchase requisition is the formal internal request a staff member submits to buy goods or services. It is the first step of the procurement cycle, starting the review and funding-verification process before a purchase order is issued.

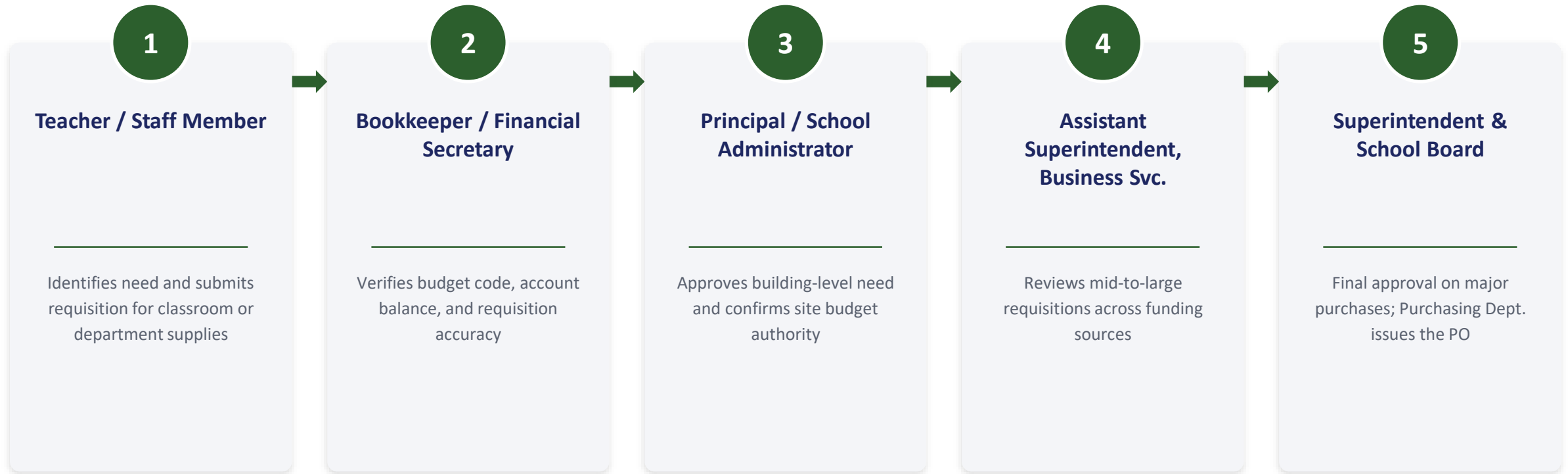
Why Approval Matters

- Protects public education dollars and taxpayer funds
- Confirms funds are budgeted and available before spending
- Creates an audit trail for state and federal compliance
- Prevents duplicate or unauthorized purchases across campuses

Approval Hierarchy



Who reviews and approves a requisition, step by step



Structure reflects common practice within K12 Schools; exact dollar thresholds are set by local policy.

Roles & Responsibilities



What each approver actually checks before signing off

Teacher / Staff Member

- Identifies the instructional or operational need
- Completes and submits the requisition form
- Attaches vendor quote or catalog information

Bookkeeper / Financial Secretary

- Checks account and budget-code accuracy
- Confirms sufficient funds remain in the line item
- Flags discrepancies before routing further

Principal / School Administrator

- Confirms the purchase supports approved school programs
- Approves within site-level spending authority
- Escalates purchases above building-level limits

Assistant Superintendent, Business Services

- Reviews larger or cross-funded requisitions (e.g., grants)
- Ensures compliance with district procurement policy
- Coordinates with Purchasing on sourcing method

Superintendent & School Board

- Grants final approval on high-value purchases
- Approves competitively bid or RFP contracts
- Purchasing Dept. converts the approved requisition into a PO

Typical Approval Thresholds

Illustrative dollar tiers seen in K12 Schools purchasing policies

1 Many districts allow principal or department-head approval for purchases under roughly \$20,000

2 Requisitions in the \$5,000–\$25,000 range often require Assistant Superintendent sign-off

3 Purchases above about \$25,000–\$36,000 typically need Superintendent approval

4 Formally bid or RFP contracts generally require School Board approval regardless of amount

These figures are illustrative examples drawn from public purchasing policies, not a universal standard — always confirm the current thresholds in your own adopted policy.



Best Practices & Common Challenges

Lessons learned from running requisition approvals at scale

Best Practices

- Standardize requisition forms and routing in a district ERP system
- Set clear, board-adopted dollar thresholds for each approval level
- Require quotes or bids at defined spending tiers
- Track approval cycle time to catch stalled requests early

Common Challenges

- Paper-based or email routing causes delays and lost requests
- Manual budget-code checks increase the risk of errors
- Multiple funding sources (general fund, grants, activity funds) complicate routing
- Staff turnover requires ongoing approver-list maintenance

Key Takeaways

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- 1 Requisition approval protects public funds and ensures policy compliance
- 2 The hierarchy scales with dollar value — site-level for small purchases, executive/board for large ones
- 3 Digitizing the workflow reduces delays and errors
- 4 Clear thresholds prevent bottlenecks and unauthorized spending